

EARTH vs. THE FLYING SAUCERS- ROUND II
"INDEPENDENCE DAY" IS ONLY A PREVIEW

UFO

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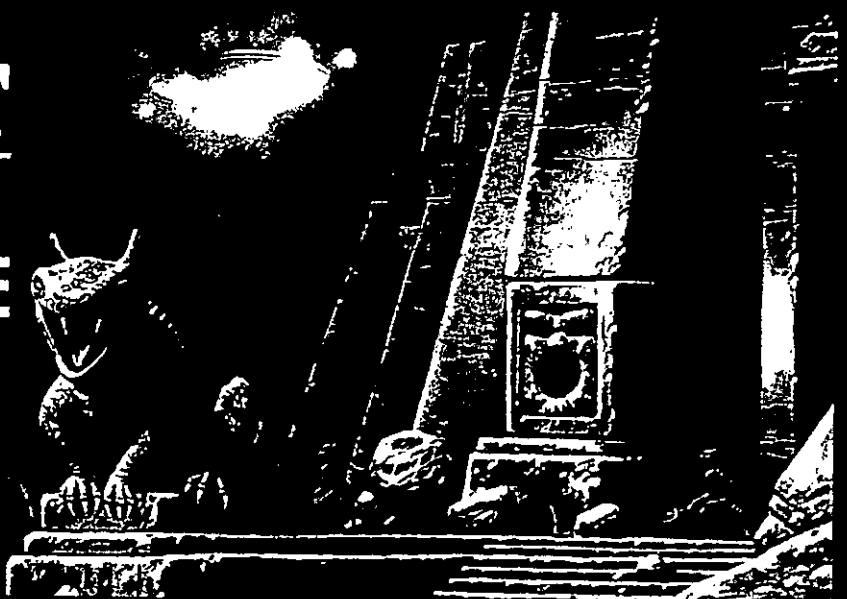
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WORLD EXCLUSIVE

"The Incident" At Edwards

by William Cutler

As our planet rushes madly through space to the year 2000, interest in the thought of extraterrestrial contact is at an all time high. Television, books and magazines all talk of the Roswell crash, secret evidence covered up, aliens on planet Earth. In short, much anecdotal information but really very little proof.

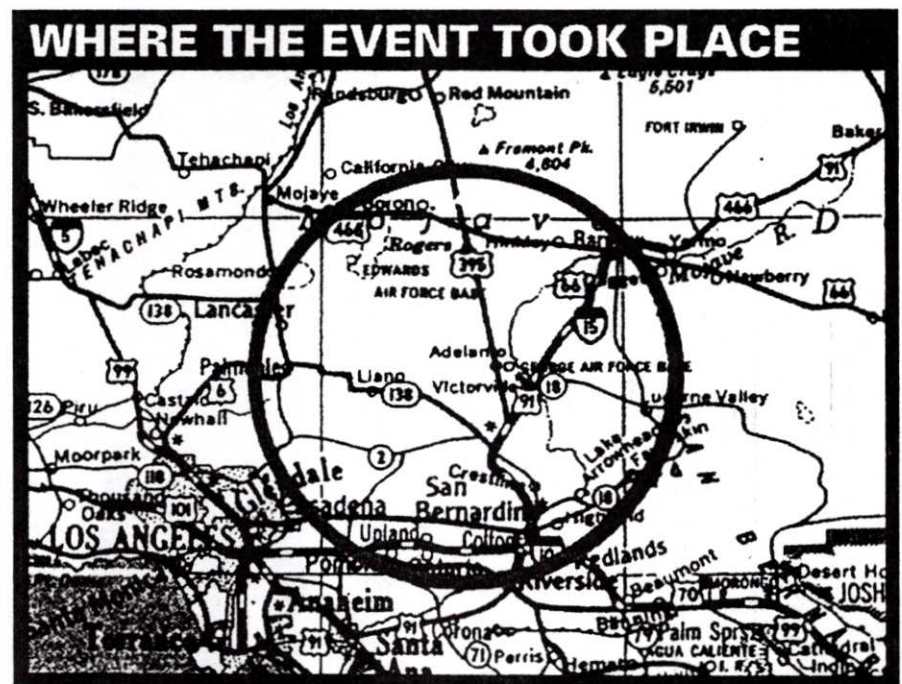
And, that is what the skeptics point to when considering if there is a UFO reality....the lack of hard evidence. Photos can be faked. Videos can be created in computers and eye witness testimony... that can be almost anything.

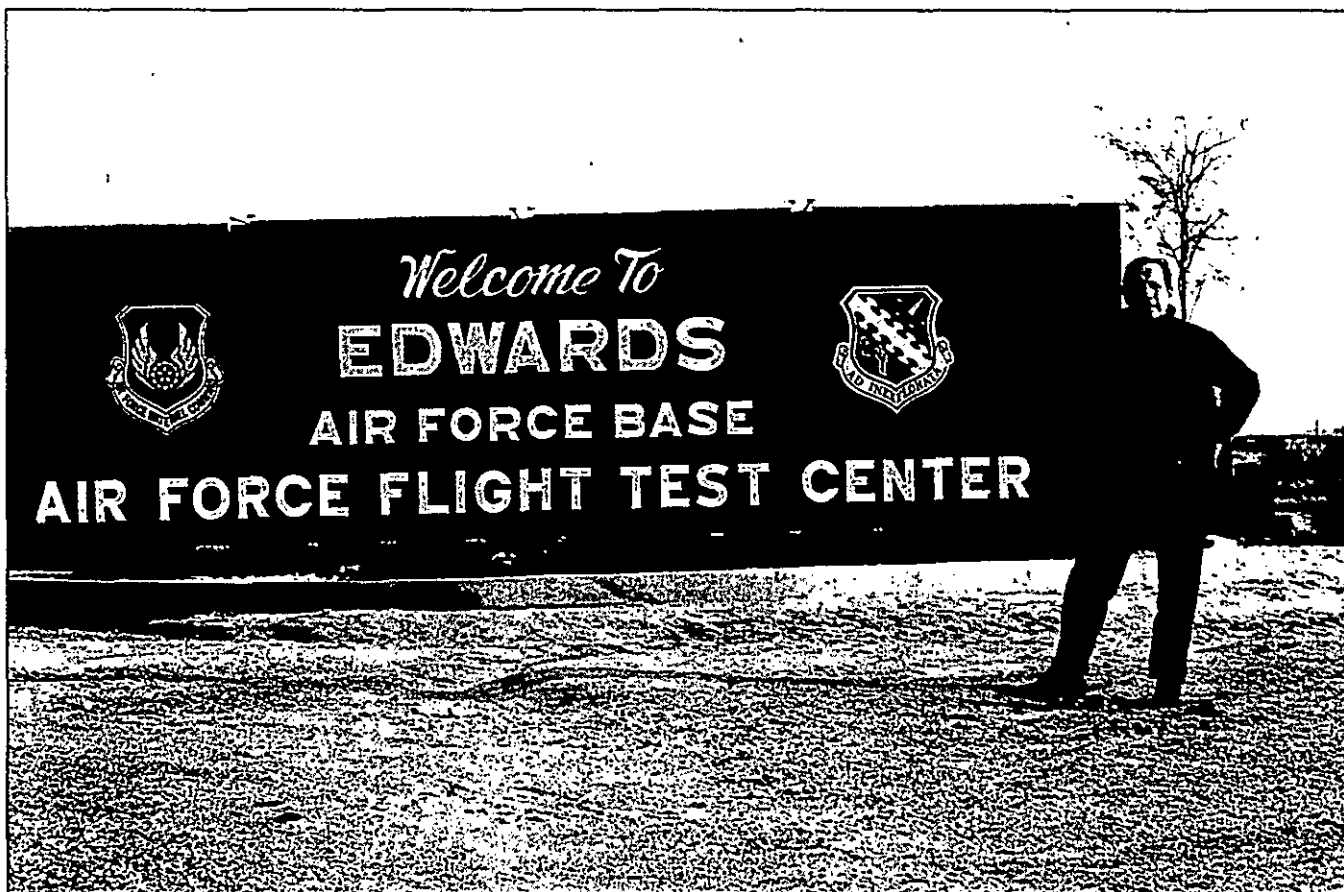
Hitting the skeptics squarely where they live is a piece of UFO evidence that has just appeared publicly...covering an event 30 years old. What is that event you say? ..."THE EDWARDS AIR FORCE BASE ENCOUNTER"—original code name: "The Incident," which took place on the night of October 7, 1965 at Edwards Air Force Base in California. This is now the subject of a 54

minute audio documentary.

For years the Air Force has had a practice of recording phone and radio conversations, when deemed important, on an extra audio track which was avail-

able for use on large rolls of radar tape. The radar tape recorders were located at Air Force bases and recorded all the signals which appeared on the radar screens for later review. If there was





Sam Sherman, producer of the audio documentary, *The Edwards Air Force Base Encounter*, investigates the UFO history of the area at Edwards Air Force Base in California.

nothing of importance on the tapes, they were erased and recorded on again and again.

Major Struble of LAADS (The Los Angeles Air Defense Sector), a division of ARADCOM (The Army Air Defense Command) authorized the making of these audio recordings on the night of October 7, 1965, when credible UFO reports began coming in from Edwards, Norton, March, Hamilton and George Air Force Bases in California' plus several other visually sighted and radar tracked locations.

LAADS was a very serious unit that was part of the Air Defense Command, protecting the western part of the US from attack from the air. They linked in with NORAD, The North American Aerospace Defense Command, a joint US-Canadian unit which still is in charge of such matters. Military personnel trained in radar and visual sightings continuously scanned both screens and skies for enemy intrusion. Experts in target identification, common planes, helicopters, stars, satellites and planets

did not put our military on alert status. Things out of the normal is what they looked for, and especially over top security air force bases.

One of the most important of such bases is/was Edwards Air Force Base, home of the Flight Test Center and NASA/Dryden—where advanced manned and unmanned planes and spacecraft are tested. Something flying low over this base and fitting no known target profile would be sure to create serious study. Especially when "alert birds" were present on the base. That is, F-106 interceptors with nuclear rockets onboard, ready for immediate takeoff and action against any enemy.

When shortly after midnight, the Edwards Tower Operator—Tech Sgt. Charles Sorrels—the Air Traffic Controller—spotted luminous objects flying low over the main Edwards runway and flashing green, red and white light, in a manner that no plane does, he contacted LAADS. The officer in charge there, Major Struble put his crew to work and they picked up evidence of the luminous

objects flying a radius of over 50 miles around the area surrounding Edwards. The evidence was visual sightings by trained Air Force personnel, RAPCON Radar and weather radar tracks and confirmation of location from several sources.

Major Healy at the 28th Air Division at Hamilton Air Force Base had the authority to give orders in a situation like this. He gave approval for Major Struble to have F-106 fighter interceptors sent up to take a closer look at the objects. NORAD did not want further information unless the situation turned "drastic."

Major Healy did make it clear to Major Struble that the planes could not be sent up without the approval of the "UFO Officer" at Edwards. Major Struble had to follow orders from Captain Balent, at Edwards—the so-called "UFO Officer." The existence of this job classification alone is startling information. If Captain Balent was just making reports on unidentified phenomena, it would not seem likely that he would

control which planes the Air Defense Command could send up. Discussions among the officers made it clear that UFO events like this had taken place before and that a policy was in effect regarding how to deal with them. The sensitive chain of command, which directed a UFO specialist to take control, seems to indicate that previous encounters with UFOs may have resulted in pilot accidents and they didn't want to take unnecessary chances.

All of the action taking place during "The Incident" was verified by audio recordings being made for a period of at least 5 hours from at least 8 locations. So, at one time, 40 hours or more of audio recordings existed on this event. Six hours of such recordings were declassified by the Department of the Air Force, but released in a chopped up time sequence, which almost defied identification and explanation. While researching a feature film docu-drama—"BEYOND THIS EARTH"—producer Samuel M. Sherman of Independent-International Pictures Corp. obtained the six hours of

tape. He felt the event had significance and planned to develop a segment in his film based on the subject. Many months were spent re-editing the tapes into their original time sequence and putting whole conversations back together that were cut apart on the tapes as released.

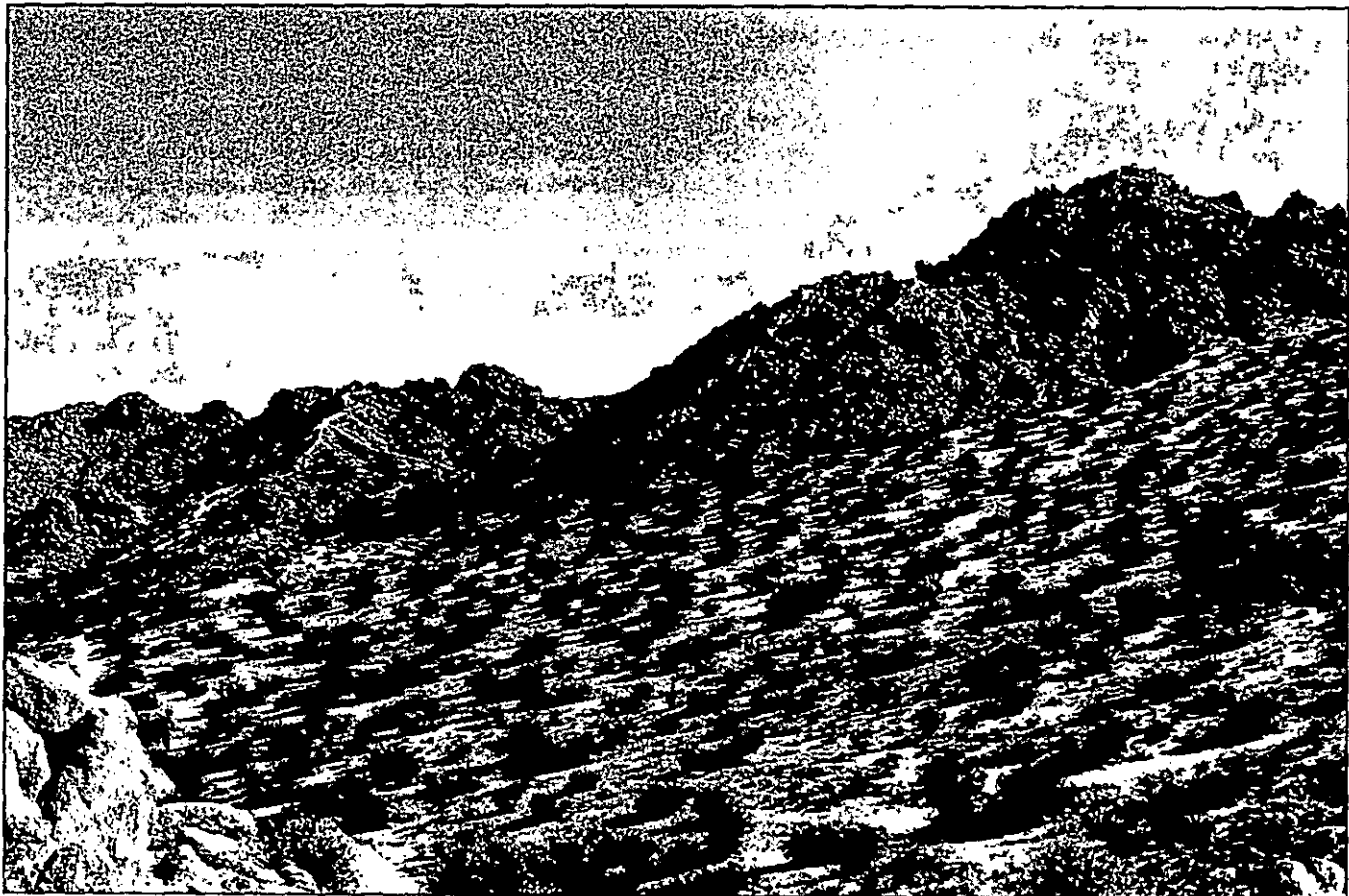
During this work sequence Sherman played the tapes for many people who were captivated by their message. Sherman decided to edit the tapes into an audio documentary and distribute them to the public. In addition to the editing—all of the recordings were enhanced by computer for greater clarity—which revealed more spoken information than was audible before this processing. The recordings were actually from phone patches, base to base radio and ground to air communications. Getting them back to clear conversations was a work of electronic art.

Research from many military organizations provided the factual basis for the documentary and getting former Tech Sgt. Charles Sorrels to help with the making of the tape was the icing on the

cake. Major George A. Filer (retired) of Air Force Intelligence consulted on the production and provided great assistance in the interpretation of the events taking place.

Veteran announcer Jackson Beck, the famed voice of Paramount News and the original Superman radio show, gave the documentary narration credibility, while Charles Sorrels' interview confirmed the whole event—with his being heard on both the old and new recordings.

The combination of editing of the archival tapes, plus narration and music gives this true life event the drama of a golden age radio program. The listener comes away with a feeling that UFOs are here and our military has been keeping an eye on them. The most compelling segment is the part where the pilot flies up amongst the luminous objects and states "contact"—when asked if he sees them indicating he does. The documentary presents the UFO information in a factual manner which should convince the most diehard skeptic, that something indeed has been go-



Desert area near Edwards Air Force Base in the Palmdale-Lancaster area in California—area where UFOs were sighted on the night of October 7, 1965.



Sam Sherman's *The Edwards Air Force Base Encounter* was produced as a major two-part subject for the Paramount Television program *Sightings*. Filming out in the desert near Edwards Air Force Base (left to right)—Director Alec Griffith, reporter Carla Wahl and Sam Sherman.

ing on for some time.

Partial Transcript of Edwards Encounters— Edited for Clarity

You are about to read authentic, declassified Air Force audio recordings, edited into a chronological sequence from over six hours of original tapes made from phone patches, base to base communications and ground to air radio. These recordings have been electronically enhanced for greater clarity and the conversations are those of actual military personnel. Major [SOUNDS LIKE: Strubel] of a unit then known as LAADS, Los Angeles Air Defense Sector of [SOUNDS LIKE: Aradcom], U.S. Army Air Defense Command, is heard authorizing the making of these tapes.

[UNINTELLIGIBLE]

Yes, sir? This is Mr. Strubel.

[UNINTELLIGIBLE]

I'm on with you.

Uh, the, uh, man just went to get the tower boy there so he would have, some-

body to confirm his story.

Well, uh, [UNINTELLIGIBLE] record on?

They are. They've got it.

Oh, you've got it? Okay.

[SOUNDS LIKE: They're recording] [WORD?].

Recording from position [SOUNDS LIKE: INV three five] on the incident.

It's moved] to the north of us and [OVERLAPPING] [SOUNDS LIKE: one's comin'] [UNINTELLIGIBLE]

And are you comin' from north or south?

Right.

North or south at this time from Edwards?

Right. He's blinking red [OVERLAPPING] and

[OVERLAPPING] Which—

I have another red light and, uh, green light combination in sight moving very rapidly over [UNINTELLIGIBLE] at this time. I—I'm gonna check on my [SOUNDS LIKE: rapcon] to see if they have any movement, in that area.

Okay.]

Yes. Uh, [SOUNDS LIKE: LAADS] here. Say, do you all have any, uh, reports of unknown flying objects over there?

No, we haven't.

Okay. Was wonderin'. We supposedly are having quite an invasion over here. [LAUGHS]

[LAUGHS] What area? In our area?

Uh, no. It's over around, uh, Victorville and Edwards. Was wondering if any of your, uh, sights or any of your bunches over there have called anything in.

No. Nuh uh.

Okay. Fine. Thank you much.

Right.

Time: [01:08:04:16],

Right.

[SOUNDS LIKE: Got four of 'em in that vee?]

Yes, sir.

Uh, three on the bottom side and two others.

Yes, sir. Counting that, uh—So